

Facebook on PS3

The release of firmware 3.10 just broadened the social networking horizon on the PS3, adding Facebook support

Cluttered Facebook?

Soon, Facebook shall introduce 'Dashboard' for third-party applications enabling a cleaner look

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Setting up

Before you actually start writing your application, you need to register your application with Facebook and get some application-specific information that will be essential for your application to communicate with the Facebook platform. By this, we mean the API key and the secret key that needs to be specified in your code.

Log into your Facebook account and go to www.facebook.com/developers. Add the application to your Facebook profile. On the top right corner, you will see the "Set up New Application" button. Click on it. Give your application a name that helps others identify it. Agree to Facebook Terms and Conditions and click on save changes.

Now that the basic stuff is in place, you'll need a logo to associate with this application. This just makes it easy for people to recognise your application. Let us also add a description because then it becomes easy for people to find your application through the Facebook application directory. You can also add an email address that people can use for technical support.

Head over straight to the canvas tab. There you will see render methods. You have to choose between iFrame and FBML. For this example to be simple, we will use FBML. Choose it and click on save changes. You also need to populate the base and callback URL for your application. Base URL is the just the fancy URL name that other people will be using to access your application page. Facebook will provide immediate feedback if that URL is unavailable, in which case you should pick something else. The callback URL is the actual stuff that points the application to your server. Make sure you enter the URL of the folder in which your index.php and other pages are located and not the actual index.php URL.

Next head over the Advanced settings option. Select website for this example as we will be creating a traditional web app that integrates with Facebook and not a desktop app which accesses Facebook

Your own Facebook app

Facebook is the latest rage in the social networking arena. With innumerable apps out there, it's easy to get lost in Facebook. Find out how you can tap the exciting side of Facebook by creating your own app

using the API and is run like a normal desktop application.

Now go the Authentication Options tab. Here you can select who all can add your application to their Facebook account. Specify a URL in the Post-Authorize callback URL text box. It is the URL that the Facebook sends a notification to, once a user authorises your application. Select the wide option in the Default Profile Box column for a rich experience. Also fill in the URL that you want users to get redirected to after installing your application in the Post-Authorize redirect URL on the Canvas page. Make it your canvas URL, basically the URL you typed in the base URL field earlier.

Finally, Click the Submit button. You will be taken to the My Applications page where you will get access to your API key and the secret key along with other meta information about your application.

Creating your Facebook application

Now that you have your API and secret key, you are ready to create an application using the Facebook client library. We are more or less done on the Facebook site as of now. First thing you need to do now is to download the client library files of the programming language that you will be using (PHP, in our case) by going to the My Applications page or <http://www.facebook.com/developers/apps.php>. Facebook officially supports PHP and Java client libraries,

and ASP.net by its collaborated project with Microsoft – <http://www.codeplex.com/FacebookToolkit>. The unofficial libraries of several other programming languages can also be found on the Facebook Developers Wiki <http://wiki.developers.facebook.com>.

Now you need to uncompress the downloaded file and copy the client file libraries in the folder that you specified as your canvas URL while setting up your



The canvas page of settings

application. The PHP client library that we will be using is under the main folder named Facebook-platform. Next you need to create a new file named appinclude.php. You can use Dreamviewer to do this or even simple text editing softwares such as Notepad. This file will contain the Facebook initialisation code required by your application to connect to the Facebook platform. You will have to include this file in all other PHP files in your application because this will contain your API key, secret key and callback URL. Type out the following code in this file:

```
<?php
require_once '../facebook-
```